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The structure of Kanuri society

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Informants say that marriage with a dead wife's sister is a possibility and some called it a "good thing", but no such unions were ever recorded in the field. To jokingly call Wi-Yo-Sis, "wife" carries an implication of the present wife's death, and such joking is stringently avoided. Exactly the same conditions for the same reasons apply to the joking relations between a woman and her husband's younger brothers. Although the joking takes many forms the most common is for ego to joke about obtaining a sexual and/or a marriage partner for his spouse's younger siblings.

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There is a joking relationship which takes place between cross-cousins of opposite sex. It takes the following form. Ego (male speaking) jokes with his matrilineal junior cross-cousin of opposite sex, calling her wife, concubine, lover, etc., and she returns the joke calling him slave, husband, lover, etc., and extracting joking money (*kungana sulibe*) from him on the *Sala Laya* (roughly the New Year). This brings on a kind of play behaviour with the younger siblings of ego's cousin which follows the adult rules of marriage. That is to say, a joking relation with Wi-Yo-Siblings who in this case are his junior cross-cousins as well as being his joking-wife's younger siblings. Thus he will call them *tiu* (junior in-laws) and refer to them (in the situation) as *tiunyi* (my junior in-laws). Ego may change his joking-wife from time to time if there are many female junior cross-cousins, but he will call only one of them wife at any one time, arranging her younger siblings into *tiu* (junior in-laws). This follows the adult practice of only marrying one of the available cousins at one time. Given no joking-wife among the matri-kin, ego may go through exactly the same joking  73 play with his patrilineal cousins. As in the matrilineal case, if ego changes his joking-wife, the *tiu* joking relationships shift also in association with the change. That is to say, these joking relationships may

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change in their personnel from time to time, but are ordered in relation to the adult marriage rules in each separate situation.

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